a distrust dating back to his internment, as he voraciously followed American culture, sports, and news.

In 1999, after tossing aside what appeared to be an anonymous form letter sent from an American government agency, he nearly threw away a $20,000 reparation check from the government. This would not be the only time the federal government would reach out to Tajiri or his family about its repressive past. After his death, Tajiri's family accepted a posthumous distinction on his behalf. In 2011, he, along with the rest of the 442nd Regimental Combat Team of Nisei soldiers, who fought for the United States after being imprisoned in internment camps, were awarded the Congressional Medal of Freedom by President Barack Obama. Each medal was inscribed with the words of their commonly held slogan: "Nisei Soldiers of World War II—Go for Broke."

Poet Audre Lorde carried forward her reflections on border crossing and its poetic transformations through the historical brink of 1989. In a range of formats, including poetry, journals, letters, and opinion editorials, Lorde weighed the significance of a reunified Berlin, especially for Afro-Germans and others of the diaspora, including herself, around the dialectic of freedom of violence. The phrase "Berlin Wall" entered her lexicon most clearly after the Wall was breached in 1989. On the day after the border's initial dismantling began on November 10, 1989, Lorde wrote an unpublished journal entry evoking the words "Berlin Wall" as she reflected on the flood of East Germans visiting retail shops in West Berlin and noting her fear and skepticism on what the Wall coming down would mean for foreign workers.[28] Lorde spelled out more of her apprehension in another unpublished entry dated January 5, 1990, questioning challenges to freedom for Afro-Germans, as well as the balance of geopolitics and safety more broadly, including in the United States for people of color.[29]

In each case, Lorde called out the Berlin Wall more directly by name, as opposed to through poetic nomenclature or political allusions from *Our Dead Behind Us*, to recognize the concrete border's newfound symbolism and public feelings of historical estrangement in this *Wende* period. She treated the Wall as a gateway to a future of reunification that also risks spikes in xenophobic violence in Germany. She also wondered about Berlin's future as a site of precarious American geopolitics. In these journals, Lorde highlighted the Berlin Wall to bring into relief broader